The Etese Grammar

Etkes Itreumis

The following article goes over the grammatical rules of the constructed language Etese, it is mainly organised by parts of speech.

1. Overview & Trivia

Etese is a language characterised by a unique feature I like to call "optional affixes", they're morphemes that can add additional meaning to words, but are completely optional. An example of this the plural suffix *-nt*, any noun in Etese has an ambiguous grammatical number, which usually has to be deduced from pragmatic or syntactical context. Here are some examples:

*"Resun **neu** soan" - "I have **two** houses"*

In this case, adding a suffix to *"soan"* would be redundant, since the number is already specified

*"lu **lia** mänai ém gale" - "The people **are** curious to know"*

Here the verb *"lia"* is in its 3rd person plural conjugation, so we can write *"iu"* instead of *"iunt"*.

In both those examples we could of course still attatch the suffix, but it's not compulsory.

Etese is a language isolate, however it does have certain influences from PIE languages, you may see some of them for example in the verb conjugation patterns, which largely resemble slavic languages.

2. Verbs

All Etese verbs end in the letter -e (eg. gale, rese), which used to be pronounced, but is now silent, unless the word is monosyllabic. It is however not redundant, as it alters the pronunciation, when we attatch suffixes, more on that later.

We differentiate between 6 tenses in Etese, those are past perfect, past imperfect, present, future perfect and future imperfect.

Tenses and their respective conjugations

Present tense

The present tense

	Pronoun	Indicative	Negative	Present conditional
1p, sg	eš	galun	galuj	galum
2p, sg	oa	gali	galij	galim
3p, sg	seu, ve	gale	galej	galem
1p, pl	é	galeme	galemej	galemem
2p, sg	au	galete	galetej	galetem
3p, sg	seun, ven	galan	galaj	galam

Past tense

In the past tense

	Perfective aspect	Imperfective aspect	Ambiguous aspect	Past perfect conditional	Past imperfect conditional
affirmative	galäs	galis	gals	galäsem	galisem
negative	galäsi	galisi	galsi	galäsemi	galisemi

Word formation

There are two main suffixes which can form verbs, these are **-ete** and **-eje**. The former indicates that the verb is **transitive**, and an action is being done to the object. The latter means the verb is **intransitive**, the action only affects the subject.
For example we can take the word *"man"*, Etese for "place", from that you can form *"manete"* - to place something somewhere and *"maneje"* - to be placed, found somehwere.
Those suffixes can however also be attatched to other verbs to alter their meaning, for example take *"gale"* - *"to know"* becomes *"galete"* - *"to inform"*

Another important suffix worth mentioning is **-are**, the frequentative suffix, which can be attatched to verbs, to indicate that an action is repeated, habitual.

3. Nouns

Case	u-noun				
accuso-nomaintive	itu	nätiset	Europä	para	näulie
explicit accusative	itot	anätis	Europät	parat	näuliet
dative	aitu	nätisu	Aseuropä	apara	anäulie
genitive	neitu	nenätiset	Neeuropä	nepara	nenäulie
locative-instrumental	itou		Neü	parasu	näuliesu

4. Adjectives and adverbs

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